

SAMIR & VINEET JAIN

53 AND 41, MEDIA BARONS (9)

DAILY HEROES

BECAUSE though the lines between news and commerce are blurring in their newspapers, readers don't seem to have realised it. Because their unlisted Bennett, Coleman and Co. Ltd (BCL), with an estimated turnover of Rs 4,000 crore, has become one of the largest private equity investors in India with stakes ranging from 1 per cent to 15 per cent across 140 companies giving them a stranglehold over advertisers. Because the value of the stake in just the 36 publicly traded partners amounts to over Rs 1,500 crore. Because their ad-for-equity model is being followed by other media houses. Because their group publications sell over six million copies in 2,400 cities. Because they have a presence in all media sectors now, with two TV channels, 32 radio stations and now even a PR company. Because their ultimate dream is to become an investment house.

WHILE VINEET LOVES TO BE IN THE LIMELIGHT, SAMIR IS MOSTLY SEEN AT SATSANGS AT THEIR HOME.

Vineet Jain



DIVISION OF LABOUR: In *The Times of India*, still the jewel in their crown, the vice-chairman, Samir Jain, looks after the edit page and the managing director, Vineet Jain, decides promotions and increments. The vc is the visionary and the MD is the doer.

BIG MOVE: From Haridwar to two homes in Goa, where the vc spent the winter months, soaking up the sun.

BIGGEST DISAPPOINTMENT: For elder brother Samir, that his daughter Trishla wants to stay on in the US after graduating from Stanford.